

Static GK Test -10

Q1. When is the National Voters Day observed by the Election Commission of India?

- A) 6 May
- B) 26 June
- C) 15 August
- D) 25 January**

Solution: 10.(d) National Voters Day is observed on 25 January by the Election Commission of India. The objective of this day is to encourage young voters to take part in the political process. It was started on 26 January 2011 to mark the Election Commission's foundation.

Q2. Yamini Krishnamurthy is known for which classical dance form?

- A) Bharatanatyam and Kuchipudi**
- B) Manipuri and Odissi
- C) Mohiniyattam and Manipuri
- D) Kuchipudi and Mohiniyattam

Solution: 3.(a) Mungara Yamini Krishnamurthy is an Indian dancer of Bharatanatyam and Kuchipudi styles of dancing. She was awarded the Padma Shree (1968), Padma Bhushan (2001), and Padma Vibhushan (2016).

Q3. As per Census 2011, what is the female literacy rate of India (provide an approximate range)?

- A) 80-89%
- B) 70-79%
- C) 60-69%**
- D) 50-59%

Solution: 13.(c) As per census 2011, The literacy rate in the country is 74.04 per cent, 82.14 for males and 65.46 for females. Kerala has the highest total literacy rate and female literacy rate whereas Lakshadweep has the highest male literacy rate. Andhra Pradesh has the lowest overall literacy rate. Rajasthan has the lowest male literacy rate, while Bihar has the lowest female literacy rate.

Q4. Who among the following is the author of the book 'Sea of Poppies'?

- A) Amitav Ghosh**
- B) Salman Rushdie
- C) Rohinton Mistry
- D) Vikram Chandra

Solution: 1.(a) Amitav Ghosh is the author of the book Sea of Poppies. He was shortlisted for the Man Booker Prize in 2008. Sea of Poppies is the first volume of the Ibis trilogy (comprising Sea of Poppies, River of Smoke, and Flood of Fire). Other famous books by Amitav Ghosh are River of Palace, The Glass Palace, and The Shadow Lines.

Q5. Which of the following cities is closest to the location of Pushkar Fair?

- A) Ahmedabad
- B) Ajmer**
- C) Prayagraj
- D) Amravati

Solution: 16.(b) Ajmer is closest to the location of Pushkar Fair. Pushkar Fair is held every year in Pushkar city in Ajmer district of Rajasthan. It is a pilgrimage site for Hindus and Sikhs.

Q6. _____ describe the idea of evolution in his book, "The origin of species".

- A) Edward Jenner
- B) Charles Darwin**
- C) Robert Brown
- D) Aristotle

Solution: 1. (b) Charles Darwin. Famous books by Charles Darwin: "On The Origin of Species", "The Autobiography of Charles Darwin", "The Descent of Man, and Selection in Relation to Sex", "The Expression of the Emotions in Man and Animals", "Insectivorous Plants", "On Natural Selection", "The Voyage of the Beagle". Edward Jenner (discoverer of a vaccine for smallpox), Robert Brown (discovery of the nucleus of the cell), Aristotle

(Father of Biology).

Q7. Identify the famous Indian classical dancer. She is a Guru of both Bharatanatyam and Odissi dancing styles. She received the Sangeet Natak Akademi Award in 1987.

- A) Shovana Narayana
- B) Sonal Mansingh**
- C) Padma Subrahmanyam
- D) Mrinalini Sarabhai

Solution: 15.(b) Sonal Mansingh: Awards - Padma Bhushan (1992), Padma Vibhushan in 2003, Lifetime Achievement Award (2019). Shovana Narayan (Kathak dancer): Awards - Padma Shri (1992), Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1999–2000). Padma Subrahmanyam (Bharata Natyam dancer): Awards - Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1983), Padma Bhushan (2003), Padma Shri (1981). Mrinalini Sarabhai (Bharatanatyam): Awards - Padma Bhushan (1992), Padma Shri (1965).

Q8. In which state of India is the Natyanjali festival celebrated?

- A) Goa
- B) Tamil Nadu**
- C) Uttar Pradesh
- D) Rajasthan

Solution: 8.(b) Famous festivals of Tamilnadu: Pongal, Puthandu (Tamil New year falls in mid-April), Natyanjali Dance Festival, Thaipusam, Mahamaham Festival, Thiruvaiyaru Festival, Karthigai Deepam, Vinayaka Chaturthi, Panguni Uthiram, Chitri Rai Festival, etc.

Q9. Rural Employment Generation Programme (REGP) was launched in _____.

- A) 1995**
- B) 1990
- C) 1999
- D) 1992

Solution: 2.(a) The Khadi & Village Industries Commission (KVIC) launched the Rural Employment Generation Programme (REGP) on 1st April 1995 for the generation of two million jobs under the KVI sector in the rural areas of the country.

Q10. The Rampurva bull that was part of a Mauryan pillar found in Rampurwa, Bihar is now placed at _____.

- A) Pradhan Mantri Bhavan
- B) Sansad
- C) Rajpath
- D) Rashtrapati Bhawan**

Solution: 10.(d) Rashtrapati Bhawan. The Pillars of Ashoka are the most famous examples of Mauryan art. The Rashtrapati Bhawan houses the imposing 3rd century BC Ashoka pillar of sandstone known as the Rampurva bull. It got its name from the place of its discovery, Rampurwa in Bihar. The Rampurva bull is installed on a plinth between the central pillars at the forecourt entrance of Rashtrapati Bhawan.

Q11. Which among the following Buddhist Universities is located in Bihar, India?

- A) Vallabhi University
- B) Somapuri University
- C) Nalanda University**
- D) Nabadwip University

Solution: 12.(c) Nalanda University (The world's first residential University) - Built by Kumaragupta (Gupta dynasty). Prominent Rulers - Harshavardhana of Kannauj, Pala Rulers, and many scholars patronized Nalanda. Muhammad Bakhtiyar Khilji - Destroyed Nalanda University, with an intent to evade the roots of knowledge, Buddhism, and Ayurveda. He set fire to the library of Nalanda. It was featured in the UNESCO World Heritage List on January 9, 2009.

Q12. When is National Girl Child Day observed annually in India?

- A) 5 June
- B) 9 September
- C) 12 May
- D) 24 January**

Solution: 6.(d) On 24 January is the National Girl Child Day observed annually in India. It was started by the Ministry of Women and Child Development and the Government of India in 2008. The purpose of the celebration is to spread awareness among people about all the inequalities faced by girls in Indian society.

Q13. Which of the following dance forms did NOT originate in South India?

- A) Kathakali
- B) Kuchipudi
- C) Sattriya**
- D) Bharatanatyam

Solution: 14.(c) Sattriya dance (Assam). Kathakali (Kerala), Kuchipudi (Andhra Pradesh), Bharatanatyam (Tamil Nadu). More famous dance forms of South India :- Kummi (Tamil Nadu), Padayani (Kerala), Kolannalu (Andhra Pradesh), Mayilattam (Tamil Nadu), Veerageese (Karnataka), Theyyam (Kerala), Perini Thandavam (Telangana), Garadi (Tamil Nadu), Thapetta Gullu (Andhra Pradesh), Oppana (Kerala).

Q14. Bharatanatyam is a classical dance form of which Indian state?

- A) Kerala
- B) Tamil Nadu**
- C) Assam
- D) Manipur

Solution: 5.(b) 8 classical dances of India: Bharatnatyam (Tamil Nadu), Kathak (Uttar Pradesh), Kuchipudi (Andhra Pradesh), Odissi (Odisha), Kathakali (Kerala), Sattriya (Assam), Manipuri (Manipur), and Mohiniyattam (Kerala).

Q15. 'Margomkali', a ritual folk art form, is from the state of ____.

- A) Assam
- B) Kerala**
- C) Nagaland
- D) Punjab

Solution: 12.(b) 'Margomkali', a ritual folk art form of Kerala. It is a dance form of the Syrian Christians of Kottayam and Thrissur districts in which dancers sing and dance around a lighted wick lamp (Nilavilakku).

Q16. In which state of India is Saga Dawa or the Triple Blessed Festival celebrated?

- A) Karnataka
- B) Andhra Pradesh
- C) Uttar Pradesh
- D) Sikkim**

Solution: 6.(d) Famous Festivals In Sikkim: Losoong Festival, Losar Festival, Bhumchu Festival, Saga Dawa, Lhabab Duchen Festival, Hee Bermiok Festival, Tendong Lho Rum Faat, International Flower Festival, Mangan Music Festival, Annual Sikkim Paragliding Festival, etc.

Q17. Rani Karnaa Nayak, who was awarded the Padma Shri in 2014, was a _____ dancer.

- A) Odissi
- B) Mohiniyattam
- C) Kathak**
- D) Kathakali

Solution: 2.(c) Kathak. Awards and Honors : Vice-President's Gold Medal - Shankar's Weekly (1954), Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1996), Order of the Queen of Laos (1964), Sangeet Varidhi - Bharatiya Kala Kendra, New Delhi (1977). Samskritiki Shreyaskar Kolkata is a dance academy founded in 1995, by Rani Karnaa.

Q18. How many times did India organise the Commonwealth Games?

- A) Once**

- B) Twice
- C) Thrice
- D) Never

Solution: 5.(a) Once (2010). In the Commonwealth Games (2010), India won 101 medals - 39 gold medals, 26 silvers and 36 bronze to finish second on the medals leaderboard. 1st Commonwealth games (1930) were held in Hamilton, Canada. Commonwealth Games to be held in Victoria (Australia) in 2026. Legendary sprinter Milkha Singh became the first Indian to win a gold medal at the Commonwealth Games (1st place in men's 440 yard event at Cardiff Commonwealth Games 1958.).

Q19. Who is the author of the book 'Gone Girl'?

- A) Damon Galgut
- B) Gillian Flynn**
- C) Yann Martel
- D) Anna Burns

Solution: 10.(b) Gillian Flynn's famous books- 'Sharp Objects', 'Dark Places', 'Gone Girl', 'The Grownup', 'The Mystery Writers of America Cookbook', etc. Damon Galgut- 'The Promise', 'The Good Doctor', 'In a Strange Room', 'Arctic Summer', 'The Quarry', etc. Yann Martel- 'Life of Pi', 'The High Mountains of Portugal Beatrice and Virgil', 'Self', etc. Anna Burns- 'Milkman', 'No Bones', 'Little Construction', etc.

Q20. Meri Policy Mere Haath scheme was launched by _____ Ministry of India in 2022.

- A) Human Resource Development
- B) Social Justice & Empowerment
- C) Housing and Urban Affairs
- D) Agriculture and Farmers Welfare**

Solution: 9.(d) Agriculture and Farmers Welfare. Chhattisgarh Agriculture Minister Ravindra Choubey launched 'Meri Policy Mere Haath' on September 1, 2022 in Raipur. Significance: The campaign empowers the farmers through crop insurance awareness and by bringing the insurance policy to their doorsteps. Other famous schemes (Chhattisgarh): Rajiv Gandhi Kisan Nyay Yojana, Godhan Nyay Yojana, Chhattisgarh Saur Sujala Yojana, Chhattisgarh Half Bijli Bill Yojana, Chhattisgarh Saraswati Cycle Yojana.

Q21. The Medical Termination of Pregnancy (MTP) Amendment Act, 2021 increases the upper limit for termination from 20 to _____ weeks for certain categories of women.

- A) 22
- B) 28
- C) 26
- D) 24**

Solution: 4.(d) 24. The Medical Termination of Pregnancy (Amendment) Bill, 2021 seeks to expand women's access to safe and legal abortion services on medical, eugenic, humanitarian or social grounds. The amendments include substitution of certain sub-sections in the existing Medical Termination of Pregnancy Act, 1971 with a view to enhance the upper gestational limit and strengthen wider access for termination of pregnancy under certain conditions, inclusion of certain new sections under certain sections is included.

Q22. What was the former name of the Yamuna Expressway Project constructed in Uttar Pradesh, India?

- A) Purvanchal Expressway
- B) Taj Expressway**
- C) Noida-Agra Expressway
- D) Kennedy Expressway

Solution: 3.(b) Taj Expressway was the former name of Yamuna Expressway. It is presently India's 3rd longest expressway since February 2017. Purvanchal Expressway is the longest expressway in India.

Q23. The Indian Institute of remote sensing was established at:

- A) Khadakwasla
- B) Shimla
- C) Dehradun**
- D) Kochi

Solution: 9.(c) Dehradun. Aryabhatta Research Institute of Observational Sciences (ARIES) in Nainital, Uttarakhand. National Remote Sensing Centre (NRSC) in Hyderabad. Space Applications Centre (SAC) in Ahmedabad, Gujarat. Satish Dhawan Space Centre SHAR (SHAR or SriHarikota Range) in Nellore district, Andhra Pradesh.

Q24. When is the Hindi Diwas observed annually?

- A) 14 March
- B) 6 April
- C) 14 September**
- D) 2 October

Solution: 7.(c) The Hindi Diwas is observed annually on 14 September and aims to raise awareness about the language and also commemorate the event when Hindi was adopted as one of the official languages of India.

Q25. Where is the headquarters of the Badminton World Federation located?

- A) Malaysia**
- B) Japan
- C) Singapore
- D) Switzerland

Solution: 20.(a) The headquarters of the Badminton World Federation is located in Malaysia. It was founded in 1934 as the International Badminton Federation with nine member nations (Canada, Denmark, England, France, Ireland, Netherlands, New Zealand, Scotland and Wales).

Q26. As per the Census 2011, what was the literacy rate of Kerala? (Provide an approximate range.)

- A) 91-95 %**
- B) 80-85%
- C) 96-100%
- D) 86-90%

Solution: 7.(a) According to the 2011 census, The overall literacy rate in India is 74% (Males- 82.14%; Females- 65.46%), Lowest Literacy rate (Bihar- 63.82%), and Highest literacy rate (Kerala; 94%).

Q27. Who among the following wrote the non-fiction 'The Paradoxical Prime Minister: Narendra Modi and His India'?

- A) Shashi Tharoor**
- B) Arundhati Roy
- C) Salman Rushdie
- D) Chetan Bhagat

Solution: 2.(a) 'The Paradoxical Prime Minister: Narendra Modi and His India' is a 2018 non-fiction book written by a senior leader of the Indian national congress, Shashi Tharoor, about the Prime minister of India, Narendra Modi.

Q28. Sundaram Balachander has been the main player of which of the following musical instruments?

- A) Mridangam
- B) Bansuri
- C) Veena**
- D) Santoor

Solution: 7.(c) Veena. Awards to S Balachander :- Padma Bhushan (1982), Sangeetha Kala Shikhamani (1982). Famous Artists of Veena : Rajhesh Vaidhya, Jayanthi Kumaresh, Nageswara Rao, E. Gayathri etc. King Samudragupta was also a great Veena Player.

Q29. The Chera Panhara ritual is associated with:

- A) Baisakhi in Punjab
- B) Durga Puja in West Bengal
- C) Navratri in Gujarat
- D) Rath Yatra in Odisha**

Solution: 7.(d) The Chera Panhara ritual is the most famous ritual associated with the Jagannath Puri Rath Yatra. The Gajapati Maharaja perform the Chhera Pahanra, which involves sweeping of the decks of the chariots with a gold-plated broomstick on Rath Yatra.

Q30. 'Elelakkaradi' is a tribal dance form of which Indian state?

- A) Goa
- B) Kerala**
- C) Rajasthan
- D) Jharkhand

Solution: 8.(b) Eight Tribal Dances of India ⇒ Elelakkaradi Dance ⇒ Kerala, Santhali Dance ⇒ West Bengal, Jharkhand & Odisha, Bamboo Dance ⇒ Mizoram, Kalbelia Dance ⇒ Rajasthan, Bhagoria Dance ⇒ Madhya Pradesh, Chhau Dance ⇒ West Bengal, Jharkhand & Odisha, Dhimsa Dance ⇒ Andhra Pradesh, Shad Suk Mynsiem ⇒ Meghalaya.

Q31. Bharatnatyam and Kuchipudi dancer Yamini Krishnamurthy was awarded which of the following awards in 2016

- A) Padma Bhushan
- B) Padma Shri
- C) Tagore Puraskar
- D) Padma Vibhushan**

Solution: 1.(d) Padma Vibhushan, Padma Shri (1968), Padma Bhushan (2001), "Natya Shastra" award by Shambhavi School of Dance (2014). Book -A Passion for Dance: My Autobiography.

Q32. 'Straight from the Heart' is the autobiography of which of the following famous personalities?

- A) Sachin Tendulkar
- B) Rahul Dravid
- C) Kapil Dev**
- D) Sunil Gavaskar

Solution: 4.(c) Kapil Dev- 'Straight from the Heart', Sachin Tendulkar- 'Playing it my Way', Rahul Dravid- 'The Nice Guy Who Finished First', Sunil Gavaskar - 'Sunny Days'.

Q33. Who among the following is the co-founder of Darpana Academy of Performing Arts?

- A) Pt. Birju Maharaj
- B) Uday Shankar
- C) Mallika Sarabhai
- D) Mrinalini Sarabhai**

Solution: 11.(d) Mrinalini Sarabhai (Bharatnatyam) is the co-founder of Darpana Academy of Performing Arts. Birju Maharaj is the Father of Kathak and exponent of the Lucknow "Kalka-Bindadin" Gharana. Uday Shankar is known as the Father of Dance In India. Mallika Sarabhai is a noted Kuchipudi and Bharatanatyam dancer.

Q34. Who among the following is famous for playing the musical instrument 'Sarod'?

- A) Amjad Ali Khan**
- B) Bismillah Khan
- C) Zakir Hussain
- D) Ravi Shankar

Solution: 14.(a) Amjad Ali Khan (Sarod Samrat). Awards - Padma Vibhushan (2001), Padma Bhushan (1991), Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1989). Other Sarod Players - Satyaki Banerjee, Jotin Bhattacharya, Ali Akbar Khan, Amaan Ali Khan, Abhisek Lahiri, Kalyan Mukherjee. Bismillah Khan - Shehnai, Ravi Shankar - Sitar Player, Zakir Hussain - Tabla Player.

Q35. In which present-day state will you find the Megudi temple?

- A) Tamil Nadu
- B) Odisha
- C) Karnataka**
- D) Kerala

Solution: 17.(c) The Megudi temple is present in Karnataka. Megudii Jain temple is a monument in Aihole, constructed in 634 AD in Dravidian style of architecture.

Q36. Who among the following won a Padma Vibhushan award in year 1971?

- A) Rajeev Narayan
B) S Swaminathan
C) Devjani Chaliha
D) Uday Shankar

Solution: 15.(d) Uday Shankar (fusion style) was the father of modern dance in India. He created the dance form (Hi-dance). Awards and honours: Sangeet Natak Akademi award (1960), Sangeet Natak Akademi Fellowship (1962), Padma Vibhushan (1971), Desikottama, Visva-Bharati University (1975).

Q37. The language 'Idu Mishmi' is spoken in the state of ____.

- A) Kerala
B) Punjab
C) Arunachal Pradesh
D) Madhya Pradesh

Solution: 13.(c) The language Idu Mishmi is spoken by the Mishmi people of Arunachal Pradesh.

Q38. As per Census 2011, which of the following states of India has the highest population?

- A) Uttar Pradesh**
B) Tamil Nadu
C) Bihar
D) Chhattisgarh

Solution: 14.(a) According to 2011 Census, top 10 populated states are Uttar Pradesh (maximum), Maharashtra, Bihar, West Bengal, Andhra Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Tamil Nadu, Rajasthan, Karnataka, and Gujarat.

Q39. Black Card given to a badminton player during the game indicates :

- A) suspension
B) fault
C) warning
D) disqualification

Solution: 3.(d) Disqualification. Terminology of Badminton - Backcourt, Birdie, Carry, Center position, Clear, Cross-court, Double hit, Drop shot, Drive, Fault, Flick, Forecourt, Kill, Let, Mid-court, Push shot, Rally, Shuttlecock, Smash etc.

Q40. Renowned Rajasthani folk dancer Gulabo Sapera is recognized for ____ dance.

- A) Bihu
B) Garba
C) Jhumar
D) Kalbeliya

Solution: 5.(d) Kalbelia dance ('Sapera Dance' or 'Snake Charmer Dance'). It was added to UNESCO's representative list of the Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity in 2010. Gulabo was awarded the Padma Shri in 2016 for his efforts to popularize Sapera dance tradition. Other dances of Rajasthan - Ghoomar, Bhavai, Kachhi Ghodi, Gair, Chari, Terah Taal. Other dances and related artists: Bihu - Prashana Gogoi. Garba - Kairavi (the queen of Garba).

Q41. Which of the following is a work by famous Indian author Khushwant Singh?

- A) A Suitable Boy
B) Train to Pakistan
C) The Guide
D) Sacred Games

Solution: 5.(b) Khushwant Singh - Train to Pakistan, Vikram Seth - A Suitable Boy, R. K Narayan- The Guide, Vikram Chandra- Sacred Games.

Q42. Which Indian boxer won a bronze medal in the middleweight division in boxing at the 2008 Beijing Olympics?

- A) Vijender Singh**
B) Mary Kom
C) Akhil Kumar
D) Jitender Kumar

Solution: 1.(a) Vijender Singh Beniwal is a boxer who won a bronze medal at the 2008 Beijing Olympics, becoming the first Indian boxer to win an

Olympic medal. He was awarded the Padma Shri in 2010. 2021 Olympics: Gold medal (Neeraj Chopra), Silver medal (Mirabai Chanu, Ravi Kumar Dahiya), and Bronze medal (PV Sindhu, Lovlina Borgohain, Bajrang Punia, and Men's hockey team).

Q43. Raja Parba festival of Odisha is the living cultural heritage and agricultural way of life. It is held for three days in the month of ____.

- A) July
B) June
C) September
D) August

Solution: 13.(b) June. Raja Parba - Dedicated to Mother Earth (Bhuma Devi) and womanhood at large. The festival marks the arrival of the monsoon season or solar month of Mithuna. Pahili Raja (the first day of the festival), Mithuna Sankranti (second day), Bhu daha or Basi Raja (Third day). Other festivals of Odisha - Kalinga Mahotsav, Konark Dance Festival, Mahabisuva Sankranti, Magha Saptmi.

Q44. Who among the following Indian dancers was the first woman in Indian history to be nominated as a member of the Rajya Sabha?

- A) Rukmini Devi Arundale**
B) Madhuri Dixit
C) Mallika Sarabhai
D) Saroj Khan

Solution: 13.(a) Rukmini Devi Arundale. She was an Indian theosophist, dancer, and choreographer of the Indian classical dance form of Bharatanatyam, and an activist for animal welfare. She was awarded the Padma Bhushan (1956) Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1957), and Sangeet Natak Akademi Fellowship (1967).

Q45. Where is the headquarters of the International Hockey Federation (FIH) located?

- A) Australia
B) Nepal
C) Switzerland
D) Bhutan

Solution: 18.(c) The headquarters of the International Hockey Federation (FIH) is located in Switzerland. FIH is the international governing body of field hockey and indoor field hockey.

Q46. Virupaksha Temple is situated in which of the following districts of Karnataka?

- A) Chikballapur
B) Bidar
C) Ballari
D) Bagalkot

Solution: 14.(c) Virupaksha Temple is situated in the Ballari district of Karnataka. It is part of the Group of Monuments at Hampi, designated as a UNESCO World Heritage Site. The temple is dedicated to Lord Virupaksha, a form of Shiva.

Q47. What is the difference in the number of years between the summer and winter Olympic events?

- A) 1
B) 2
C) 4
D) 3

Solution: 10.(b) 2 years. The Olympic Games are normally held every four years. First summer Olympic games: 6 April 1896 {Greece (Athens)}. Summer Olympic games 2020: Tokyo. First winter Olympic games: 1924 (France). Winter Olympic Games 2022: Beijing (China). The FIFA world cup and Cricket world cup are held every four years.

Q48. When is the statehood day of Tripura observed?

- A) 21 January**
B) 12 March
C) 21 February
D) 3 October

Solution: 8.(a) Tripura was conferred statehood on 21 January. January 21, 2021 marked the 49th statehood day of northeastern states Manipur, Tripura, and Meghalaya.

Q49. Which ancient Indian sport pits crowds of brave young men against angry bulls?

- A) Kho-Kho
- B) Jallikattu**
- C) Kabaddi
- D) Mallakhamb

Solution: 14.(b) Jallikattu is typically practiced in the Indian state of Tamil Nadu as a part of Pongal celebrations on Mattu Pongal day, which occurs annually in January.

Q50. 'Panche' is a traditional sarong worn by the men in the state of _____.

- A) Kerala
- B) Karnataka**
- C) Assam
- D) Sikkim

Solution: 15.(b) Panche is a traditional sarong worn by the men in the state of Karnataka. Another name of Panche is 'Dhoti'. This unstitched cloth is wrapped around the legs and knotted around the waist.

Q51. According to census 2011, number of literates in India is _____ million.

- A) 767.5
- B) 765.5
- C) 769.5
- D) 763.5**

Solution: 12.(d) The number of literates in India is 763.5 million in Census 2011 {Male: 82.14% and Female: 65.46%}. Kerala has the highest literacy rate {94%: Male - 96.11% and female - 92.07%}. Lowest literacy rate: Bihar {69.83%: Male - 70.32% and female - 53.57%}.

Q52. As per the 2011 census, what was the percentage of the urban population in India?

- A) Between 30% and 35%**
- B) Between 40% and 45%
- C) Between 10% and 15%
- D) Between 20% and 25%

Solution: 6.(a) As per the 2011 census, the percentage of the urban population in India was between 30% and 35 %. Of the 1.21 billion Indians, 833 million (68.84%) live in rural areas while 377 million stay in urban areas.

Q53. The birth anniversary of _____ was observed as 'Rashtriya Ekta Diwas' (National Unity Day) on 31st October 2020.

- A) Jawaharlal Nehru
- B) Rajendra Prasad
- C) Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel**
- D) Indira Gandhi

Solution: 11.(c) The birth anniversary of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel was observed as 'Rashtriya Ekta Diwas (National Unity Day) on 31st October 2020. It was introduced in 2014 by the government of India. Sardar Patel was an Indian Politician from Gujarat and served as the First Deputy Prime Minister and first home minister of India from 1947 to 1950. He played a leading role in the country's struggle for independence.

Q54. How is Dhanpat Rai Srivastava better known?

- A) Agyeya
- B) Dinkar
- C) Nirala
- D) Premchand**

Solution: 4.(d) Dhanpat Rai Srivastava is better known as Premchand. Premchand was an Indian writer known for his modern Hindustani literature. Some of his works include Godaan, Karambhoomi, Gaban, Mansarovar, Idgah.

Q55. What is the stone-like disc seen at the top of the temple in Odisha and nearby district's Temple architecture called?

- A) Kalasha
- B) Antarala
- C) Amalaka**
- D) Jagati

Solution: 9.(c) 'Amalaka' is one of the important elements of Temple Shikhara (Tower) in Nagara Shaili usually found in Uttara Bharatha. A mandir 'kalash' is a metal or stone spire used to top the domes of Hindu temples. 'Antarala' is a small antechamber or foyer between the garbhagriha (shrine) and the mandapa, more typical of north Indian temples. In Hindu temple architecture, the 'jagati' is the raised surface of the platform or terrace upon which some Buddhist or Hindu temples are built.

Q56. In football, when the ball strikes the frame of the goal or the referee and remains within the goal and touch lines, it is:

- A) foul
- B) still in play**
- C) a misconduct
- D) out of play

Solution: 8.(b) still in play. Other terms related to Football : Back of the net, Ball-to-hand, Bicycle kick, Box-to-box player, Chip shot, Clean sheet, Hoof, Dummy run etc.

Q57. Who among the following authored 'Poverty and Un-British Rule in India'?

- A) Jawaharlal Nehru
- B) Mahatma Gandhi
- C) Rabindranath Tagore
- D) Dadabhai Naoroji**

Solution: 3.(d) Dadabhai Naoroji authored 'Poverty and Un-British Rule in India'. He was a Parsi scholar and has authored great books such as 'Poverty of India', 'The wants and means of India' and many others.

Q58. Which God is worshipped during the festival of Chhath Puja?

- A) Surya**
- B) Agni
- C) Indra
- D) Vishnu

Solution: 6.(a) Surya. Chhath is derived from the Sanskrit word Shashthi, which means the sixth. It is celebrated in the month of Kartik to thank the Sun god for bestowing the bounties of life on Earth. Other festivals of Bihar - Buddha Jayanti, Sonepur Cattle Fair, Rajgir Mahotsav, Sama-Chakeva, Bihula, Madhushravani, Pitrapaksha Mela, Malmas Mela.

Q59. Who among the following is/was NOT a tabla player?

- A) Kishan Maharaj
- B) Zakir Hussain
- C) Allah Rakha
- D) Sheikh Chinna Moula**

Solution: 4.(d) Famous Nadhaswaram players include Sheikh Chinna Moula, Neeruswamy Pillai, Rajaratnam Pillai, etc. Famous Tabla Players in India are Alla Rakha Khan, Kishan Maharaj, Nikhil Ghosh, Zakir Hussain, etc.

Q60. 'Mudiyettu' is a traditional folk theatre form of which Indian state?

- A) Manipur
- B) Kerala**
- C) Jharkhand
- D) Assam

Solution: 1.(b) Kerala Folk theater &Arr; Mudiyettu, Bhagavati Pattu, Tolpavakoothu, Pavakathakali, Chavittu Nadakam, Oppana, Kathakali, Margamkali, Duffmuttu, Koodiyattam, Kolkali, Parichamuttukali, Chakyarkoothu, Krishnanattam, Mohiniyaattam, Kummattikali.

Q61. Sonal Mansingh was awarded the Sangeet Natak Akademi Award in 1987. She is a trained _____ dancer.

- A) Manipuri

- B) Kuchipudi
C) Odissi
D) Bihu

Solution: 12.(c) Sonal Mansingh → Famous Odissi Dancer. Guru Pankaj Charan Das is known as the 'Father of Odissi dance'. Some more famous Odissi dancers are → Jhelum Paranjape, Mayadhar Raut, Gangadhar Pradhan, Leena Citaristi, Leena Mohanty, Chitra Krishnamurti, Bijayini Satpathy, Madhavi Mudgal etc.

Q62. In which of the following states is the headquarters of IDBI (Industrial Development Bank of India) located?

- A) Haryana
B) Maharashtra
C) Karnataka
D) West Bengal

Solution: 19.(b) The headquarters of IDBI are located in Maharashtra. It was established in 1964 by an act to provide credit and other financial facilities for the development of the fledgling Indian industry.

Q63. Who among the following was the first recipient of the State annual award Nishagandhi Puraskaram from the Government of Kerala in 2013?

- A) Madhavi Mudgal
B) Shobana C Pillai
C) Uday Shankar
D) Mrinalini Sarabhai

Solution: 13.(d) Mrinalini Sarabhai (Bharatanatyam) was the founder and director of Darpana Academy of Performing Arts in Ahmedabad. Awards and honours: Padma Bhushan (1992), Padma Shri (1965), Sangeet Natak Akademi Fellowship (1994), Dhirubhai Thakar Savyasachi Saraswat Award (2014). She was the first Indian to receive the medal and Diploma of the French association Archives Internationales de la Danse.

Q64. Bonalu is a Hindu festival celebrated to worship Goddess Mahakali in which of the following states?

- A) Telangana**
B) Assam
C) Kerala
D) Madhya Pradesh

Solution: 15.(a) Famous festivals of Telangana: Bathukamma, Bonalu, Ugadi, Peerla Panduga, Medaram Jatara, Peddagattu Jatara, Edupayala Jatara, Kurumurthy Swamy Jatara, Komuravelli Mallanna Jatara, Chittaramma Jatara, Sadar, Numaish, etc.

Q65. Which famous Indian dancer is associated with the Pandavani dance form?

- A) Vyjayanthimala
B) Pandit Briju Maharaj
C) Vempati Chinna Satyam
D) Teejan Bai

Solution: 7.(d) Teejan Bai. She Awarded Padma Vibhushan in 2019, Padma Bhushan in 2003. Pandavani is a style of singing in which narration of tales from the Mahabharata is performed. It is performed in Chhattisgarh. Famous exponents of pandavani - Jhaduram Devangan, Punaram Nishad, Ritu Verma, Chetan Dewangan, Shantibai Chelak and Usha Barle. Other artists and art forms: Pandit Birju Maharaj (kathak), Vyjayanthimala (Bharatanatyam), Vempati Chinna Satyam (Kuchipudi).

Q66. Who among the following was the first Indian musician to receive the Grammy LifeTime Achievement Award?

- A) Nucleya
B) Pandit Ravi Shankar
C) Hariprasad Chaurasia
D) Ustad Zakir Hussain

Solution: 3.(b) Pandit Ravi Shankar (Bharat Ratna in 1999). He won Best Chamber Music Performance for 'West Meets East' in 1967. The Grammy Awards are presented annually by the Recording Academy of the United States. The first Grammy Awards ceremony - May 4, 1959. Other Indian Grammy winners - Zubin Mehta (1981, Best Classical Performance), T. H.

Vinayakram and Zakir Hussain (1991, Best World Music Album), Vishwa Mohan Bhatt (1993, Best World Music Album).

Q67. The famous Dhamek Stupa is located in which of the following states?

- A) Andhra Pradesh
B) Uttar Pradesh
C) Madhya Pradesh
D) Himachal Pradesh

Solution: 8.(b) Uttar Pradesh. Dhamek Stupa - It is located at Sarnath, in Varanasi. It was built in 249 B.C. by Ashoka the Great. It was made to commemorate the event of Lord Buddha giving the first sermon to his first five disciples. Other stupas: Swayambhunath Stupa - Kathmandu (Nepal), Bharhut Stupa - Satna District (Madhya Pradesh), Kesariya Stupa - Champaran District (Bihar), Sanchi Stupa - Raisen District (Madhya Pradesh), Chaukhandi Stupa - Varanasi (Uttar Pradesh).

Q68. 'Ace against Odds' is an autobiographical book by _____.

- A) V.V Giri
B) Mary Kom
C) Sania Mirza
D) Sachin Tendulkar

Solution: 2.(c) Sania Mirza (Tennis Player). Awards - Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna (2015); Padma Bhushan (2016). Autobiographies of some famous personalities: "Unbreakable" - MC Marykom. "Playing It My Way" - Sachin Tendulkar. "The Test of My Life" - Yuvraj Singh. "A Shot at History" - Abhinav Bindra. "Believe – What Life and Cricket Taught Me" - Suresh Raina. "281 and Beyond" - VVS Laxman. "Goal" - Major Dhyan Chand.

Q69. Who among the following has sung the famous Bollywood song 'Channa Mereya'?

- A) Neeti Mohan
B) Arijit Singh
C) Shreya Ghoshal
D) Sukhbir

Solution: 10.(b) Channa Mereya was sung by Arijit Singh.

Q70. Sattriya is a classical dance form of which Indian state?

- A) Manipur
B) Karnataka
C) Assam
D) Kerala

Solution: 12.(c) Dances of Assam: Bihu Dance, Jumur Nach, Ali Ai Ligang dance, Deodhani, Barpeta's Bhortal Nritya, Dhuliya and Bhawariya, Bodo's Bagurumba, Khamba Lim, Oja-Pali Dance, Satriya Dance etc.

Q71. Name the album for which Pandit Ravi Shankar won the Grammy award in 1967.

- A) Three Ragas
B) West Meets East
C) Concert for Bangladesh
D) Full circle

Solution: 11.(b) Pandit Ravi Shankar was an Indian sitarist and composer. He won Five Grammy Awards: 1967 (West Meets East), 1973 (The Concert for Bangladesh), 2002 (Full Circle: Carnegie Hall 2000), 2013 (The Living Room Sessions), and the Lifetime Achievement Award received at the 55th Annual Grammy Awards (2013).

Q72. The number of females per 1000 males in the population is called the _____.

- A) birth rate
B) sex ratio
C) death rate
D) literacy rate

Solution: 9.(b) Sex ratio. According to 2011, the state that has the highest sex ratio is Kerala (1084), and the state that has the lowest sex ratio is Haryana (879). Birth Rate (or crude birth rate) The number of live births per 1,000

population in a given year. Death Rate (or crude death rate) The number of deaths per 1,000 population in a given year. The literacy rate is defined by the percentage of the population of a given age group that can read and write.

Q73. On which of the following days is National Disaster Response Force Raising Day celebrated annually?

- A) 21 September
- B) 23 October
- C) 19 January**
- D) 6 March

Solution: 9.(c) National Disaster Response Force came into existence on January 19, 2006. NDRF celebrates its raising day annually on 19 January. This year it celebrated its 16th anniversary.

Q74. In which year was the Border Roads Organisation established?

- A) 1954
- B) 1966
- C) 1960**
- D) 1958

Solution: 15.(c) The Border Roads Organisation was formed on 7 May 1960 to secure India's borders and develop infrastructure in remote areas of the north and north-east states of the country. Headquarters is in New Delhi.

Q75. A Hindu festival celebrated by the Tamil community that falls in the Tamil Solar Month is called?

- A) Karaga
- B) Bihu
- C) Onam
- D) Thaipusam**

Solution: 6.(d) Thaipusam. Other Festivals celebrated in Tamilnadu : Pongal, Thiruvaiyaru Festival, Natyanjali Dance Festival, Mahamaham, Karthigai Deepam etc. Karaga is a folk dance of Karnataka originated as a ritual dedicated to Draupadi as known in these parts as Droupadmma. Onam is a harvest festival celebrated in Kerala. Bihu (Assam).

Q76. Rohini Bhate, recipient of Kalidas Samman was associated with which classical dance of India?

- A) Odissi
- B) Manipuri
- C) Sattriya
- D) Kathak**

Solution: 2.(d) Rohini Bhate, recipient of Kalidas Samman (2001) was associated with Kathak classical dance of India. Her Awards ⇒ 1977: State government's Maharashtra Rajya Puraskar, 1979: Sangeet Natak Akademi Award, 1990: Maharashtra Gaurav Puraskar.

Q77. Siddhendra Yogi, a doyen of the _____ dance form, was lauded as Adi Guru.

- A) Bharatanatyam
- B) Kuchipudi**
- C) Kathakali
- D) Kathak

Solution: 5.(b) Siddhendra Yogi is a doyen of the Kuchipudi dance form. He is the author of 'Bhama Kalapam', the jewel of Kuchipudi and he is the one who brought a distinctive style to Kuchipudi. Kuchipudi is one of the eight major Indian classical dances and originated in the state of Andhra Pradesh.

Q78. Which of these is the title of the first novel of Anand Neelakantan?

- A) Asura: Tale of the Vanquished**
- B) Satya Ke Prayog
- C) The Immortals of Meluha
- D) Kadambari

Solution: 11.(a) Asura: Tale of the Vanquished. Anand Neelakantan's Notable works - 'Ajaya: Roll of the Dice', 'Ajaya: Rise of Kali', 'The Rise of Sivagami', 'Penn Ramayanam', 'Valmiki's Women'. Mahatma Gandhi - 'Satya ke Prayog'. Amish Tripathi - 'The Immortals of Meluha'. Banabhatta - 'Kadambari'.

Q79. Sunanda Nair is famous for performing which of the following dance forms ?

- A) Kathak
- B) Odissi
- C) Yakshagana
- D) Mohiniyattam**

Solution: 4.(d) Mohiniyattam (classical dance of Kerala). Sunanda Nair Awards and Honors - Global Mannam award', (New York 2020), Nrithya Seva Mani award (2020), Nalanda Kanaka Nartana Puraskaar' (2017), 'Kalarathnam' from Kerala Kalamandalam (2016), Kalashree from the Kerala Sangeetha Natak Akademi (2011), 'Global Excellence Award' (2011), Kalasagar (2010), Best Ethnic Classical Arts Award, (New Orleans, 2003), 'Anantha Margaseersha Natya Puraskaram' (2018) etc.

Q80. Who among the following was the first Indian female musician to win the Grammy award?

- A) Neeti Mohan
- B) Tanvi Shah**
- C) Shweta Pandit
- D) Shalmali Kholgade

Solution: 11.(b) Tanvi Shah shared the Grammy Award for Best Song Written for Visual Media with AR Rahman and Gulzar at the 52nd Grammy Awards for the song 'Jai Ho' (Slumdog Millionaire) for writing Spanish lyrics for the song. Others Awards: BMI award in 2009, World soundtrack award (2009).